Contact Center – AI *Intent* Routing (*Voice*): Build & Configure

Use this procedure to configure **AI Intent Routing (Voice)** end-to-end: define intents, add the Intent Capture business function to your flow, connect outcomes to queues, and publish. This article assumes you already have access to voice flow design and queue management.

Refer to AI Intent Routing (Voice): Overview & FAQ for a product description, Best Practices, and FAQ.

Important: available to US, UK, and EU clients only.

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Before You Begin

- **Permissions & Access:** Verify you can sign in to Contact Center and edit voice flows and queues.
- **Intent Planning:** Identify the top 5–10 call reasons and draft one intent per reason; note any needed disambiguation between similar intents.
- **Expressions:** Prepare representative caller phrases for each intent (varied length; casual language acceptable).
- **Routing Targets:** Create or confirm queues, self-service steps, or destinations for the following outcomes: **Match**, **Low Confidence**, and **No Match**.
- **Confidence Strategy:** Choose an initial minimum confidence threshold (for example, 0.80) and define success metrics for adjustments.
- **Variables & Data:** Decide on variable names to capture matched intent and score for downstream logic and reporting.
- **Test Plan:** Set up a non-production flow or maintenance window, a test phone number, and a phrase list for UAT scenarios.

Examples of Expressions and Intents

1. Common Support Intents

Caller Says (Utterance)	What They Mean (Intent)
I forgot my password	Reset password
How do I update my email address?	Update account information

2. Update Account Information Intents

Caller Says (Utterance)	What They Mean (Intent)
I want to cancel my subscription	Cancel subscription
What's the status of my order?	Check order status
I need help with my bill	Billing support

3. Troubleshooting Intents

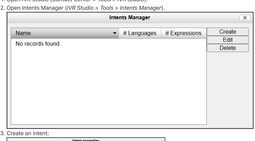
Caller Says (Utterance)	What They Mean (Intent)
My app keeps crashing	App troubleshooting
I'm not getting any notifications	Fix notification issues
Why is my account locked?	Account access issues

4. Voice Intents

Caller Says (Utterance)	What They Mean (Intent)
I need to speak with an agent	Transfer to agent
Pay my bill	Make a payment
Check my balance	Balance inquiry

Step 1: Create Intents in Intent Manager

1. Open IVR Studio (*Contact Center > Tools > IVR Studio*).
2. Open Intents Manager (*IVR Studio > Tools > Intents Manager*).



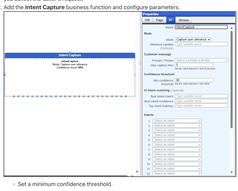
3. Create an intent:

   - Enter a clear intent name (for example, **Get me an agent**).
   - Select the expected caller language, then add up to 10 example expressions.
   - Repeat for additional languages, if needed.
4. Repeat for each high-volume call reason.

Note: Keep example phrases short, varied, and free of unnecessary punctuation.

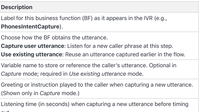
Step 2: Add the Intent Capture Business Function

1. Open your target voice flow in *Contact Center > Tools > IVR Studio* and locate the point where you collect the caller's request.
2. Add the **Intent Capture** business function and configure parameters.



   - Set a minimum confidence threshold.
   - Define outcomes for **Match**, **Low Confidence**, and **No Match**.

Parameters

Parameter	Description
Name	Label for this business function (BF) as it appears in the IVR (e.g., **PhonesIntentCapture**).
Mode	Choose how the BF obtains the utterance. **Capture user utterance**: Listen for a new caller phrase at this step. **Use existing utterance**: Reuse an utterance captured earlier in the flow.
Utterance Variable	Variable name to store or reference the caller's utterance. Optional in *Capture* mode; required in *Use existing utterance* mode.
Prompt/Phrase	Greeting or instruction played to the caller when capturing a new utterance. (Shown only in *Capture* mode.)
Max Capture Time	Listening time (in seconds) when capturing a new utterance before timing out.
Min Confidence Threshold	Minimum confidence required to treat recognition as a valid match (default: 80%; configurable). Below this value, the **Low Confidence** path is used.
Low Confidence Path	Route used when the best match is below the Min Confidence Threshold (e.g., send to general menu or agent). 
Error Path	Fallback route when no speech is detected, there is no match, or an error occurs (e.g., silence until *Max Capture Time* expires).
Best Intent Match (Variable)	Variable name to store the top matched intent label.
Best Intent Confidence (Variable)	Variable name to store the confidence score of the top matched intent.
Top Intent Matches (Variable)	Variable name to store the top five detected intents and their confidence scores (ordered highest to lowest).
Intents	Select up to 25 intents for this BF to evaluate. You can chain multiple Intent Capture BFs to support larger sets while keeping each step focused.

Step 3: Connect to Queues & Publish

1. For the **Match** outcome, connect each intent to the appropriate queue or downstream function.
2. Ensure **Low Confidence** and **No Match** outcomes route to safe fallbacks (for example, a general menu or live agent).
3. Save and publish your flow.

Important: Always include a fail-safe route to an agent to avoid dead ends.

Step 4: Test the Flow

1. From a test phone, dial into the flow and use real-world phrasing for each configured intent.
2. Capture outcomes and confidence scores; adjust **Min Confidence** and example phrases as needed.

Voice Flow Example

The following scenarios mirror common deployments. Adapt the language and routing targets to your business terms and queues.

Example Call 01 — *I just want to talk to Billing*

Jamie calls and says, "*Hi. I need help with a billing issue.*"

The system recognizes a billing need and sends the caller directly to the Billing queue—**no buttons, no menus**.

Example Call 02 — *Support, please*

Alex calls and says, "*I need help with my account.*"

The system identifies a Support request and routes to the appropriate queue. The agent receives Alex's original phrase and the matched intent for context.

Example Call 03 — *I got disconnected*

Anika calls but gets disconnected. She calls again and says, "*I called before and you cut me off.*"

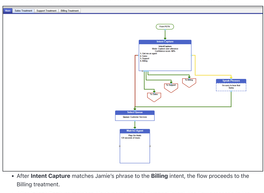
The system can't match her request to any intent assigned to the business function. It responds with, "*I'm sorry to hear that.*" Then it sends Anika to a **Customer Services** queue so a live agent can speak with her.

Example Call 04 — No Response

Mikey dials in but is on mute. After the configured **Max Capture Time** elapses without speech, the system routes to a **Customer Services** queue for live assistance.

How This Looks in a Flow

The flow below illustrates one way to implement the cases above in a voice flow designer.



- After **Intent Capture** matches Jamie's phrase to the **Billing** intent, the flow proceeds to the Billing treatment.
- After **Intent Capture** matches Alex's phrase to the **Support** intent, the flow proceeds to the Support treatment.
- If **Intent Capture** cannot match Anika's phrase to any assigned intent, the flow can play an acknowledgement (for example, a **Speak Phrases** step) and then send the call to the **Customer Services** queue.
- If no speech is detected within **Max Capture Time**, the flow follows the **Error** or **No Response** path to the **Customer Services** queue.

Is this answer helpful?
Yes
No

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